

Helpless under bombardment, the *Congress* “struck her colors,” the gesture of surrender in naval warfare, but Union soldiers on shore were unaware of this convention. As the surrender was being organized, they opened fire, seriously wounding Buchanan in the leg. In retaliation he ordered red-hot shot to be fired at the *Congress*, setting her ablaze—the ship finally blew up in the early hours of the following morning. Another frigate, USS *Minnesota*, had also run aground and was marked as the next target for destruction, but with the approach of night the *Virginia* withdrew for repairs. The Union navy had lost two ships and the lives of more than 230 sailors.